

Guidelines to Help Lower Cholesterol & Triglycerides

If you have too much *cholesterol* (a fat-like substance) or *triglycerides* (fats) in your blood it can build up in your arteries, forming plaque. This build-up of plaque can slow down or stop blood flow in an artery, causing a **heart attack** or **stroke**.

To help decrease your cholesterol and triglycerides:

Eat More of These Foods	Limit These Foods
<u>Healthy Proteins</u> (3-ounce cooked portions) • Chicken, Fish (Roasted, Grilled, Baked, Pan-Fried) without skin • Tofu, Tempeh • Lean Steak Cuts (like Round & Sirloin) • Ground Turkey <u>Soluble Fiber</u> • Oatmeal, Barley, Oat Bran • Lentils & Peas • Beans (Kidney, Lima, Black, Pinto, Navy) • Brussels Sprouts, Broccoli, Sweet Potato • Apples, Pears, Oranges, Apricots, Grapefruit • Blackberries, Raisins, Dates, Figs, Prunes <u>Unsaturated Fats (MUFAs & PUFAs)</u> • Olives & Olive Oil, Canola Oil, Soybean Oil • Avocado • Nuts (Macadamia, Hazel, Pecan, Almond, Peanut, Cashew, Pistachio, Walnut) • Natural Peanut Butter (and other nut butters made with only the nut) <u>Omega-3 Fatty Acids</u> • Wild Salmon, Mackerel, Sardines, Albacore Tuna (fresh or canned) • Flaxseed, Chia Seed, Walnuts, Soybeans • Canola Oil <u>Whole Grains</u> • 100% Whole Grain Bread, Whole Grain Pasta • Whole Grain Cereal (with at least 5 grams of fiber per serving) • Quinoa, Brown Rice • Popcorn, 100% Whole Grain Crackers	<u>Saturated Fats</u> • Fatty Meats (Ribs, Skirt Steak, any highly-marbled cuts of meat), Poultry Skin and Pig Skins, Hamburgers • Processed Meats (Sausage, Bacon, Salami, Hot Dogs, Corn Dogs "Deli" & "Luncheon" Meats) • Butter, Whole Milk • Full-Fat Cheese, Ice Cream <u>Trans Fats/Processed Foods</u> • Margarine • Salad Dressings • Packaged Baked Goods & Sweets • Convenience, Boxed, & Frozen Foods • Potato Chips, Hot Cheetos, Taki's • Instant or Ramen Noodles, Cup Noodles • Deep Fried Foods • Fast Food using "Hydrogenated" Oils <u>Refined Carbohydrates</u> • White Bread, White Pasta • Sugary or Refined Cereals • Sodas • Fruit Drinks (Kool-Aid, Sunny-D, Tang) • Fruit Juice (even 100% fruit juice) • Gatorade, Powerade, Arizona Tea • Energy Drinks, Red Bull, Monster • Other Sweets & Candies • Ice Creams, Pies, Cake, Other Desserts